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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT RECEIVES US SECRETARY OF STATE

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday received Marco Rubio, US Secretary of State. The two sides addressed regional and international issues of mutual concern, with a focus on developments in the Middle East. In this regard, Sheikh Mohamed and Rubio underscored the importance of advancing the foundations of security, stability, and lasting peace across the region. **SEE ALSO P11**

Europe wilts under historic 'heat dome'

HEATWAVE TO SPREAD OVER WESTERN, CENTRAL AND SOUTHERN EUROPE

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

Temperatures across Europe continued to soar yesterday even as weather records tumbled. As many as 94 million people across the continent struggled with heat above 35C as a historic 'heat dome' forced emergency alerts from London to Milan, with experts warning that the massive system presents a direct risk to life.

Meteorologists have warned that temperatures are set to rise even higher through today and into the weekend. Moreover, the heatwave is likely to spread over large parts of Western, Central, and Southern Europe within the next two weeks.

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Shattering records

France saw its hottest day on record on Tuesday, with an average national temperature of 29.3C, beating previous records set in July 2019 and August 2003. Authorities have warned of a high risk of forest fires amid a worsening drought. Underlining the associated dangers with the life-threatening heat, 40 people have died in drowning accidents.

In southern Spain, temperatures are forecast to reach 44C in some regions in Cordoba. In Switzerland, authorities have issued a top-level red alert for large parts of the country, including its cities of Zurich and Geneva.

In neighbouring Austria, temperatures are set to soar past 40C over the weekend, especially in the eastern and southern regions. The UK's met office has issued a red extreme heat warning, saying temperatures could breach the 40C mark today.

In Italy, a red alert blankets 16 major cities, including Rome, Milan, and Turin, with mercury readings forecast to hit 41C in Florence.

Triggering shutdowns

In France, the extreme heat caused a major power grid transformer to fail in Finistère, leaving 68,000 households without electricity. Iconic tourist landmarks, including Paris's Louvre Museum and Eiffel Tower, and Belgium's steel Atomium monument, have slashed operating hours to protect visitors.

Education and transport systems are similarly upended. France has rescheduled oral baccalaureate exams for 10,000 students, while British rail operators have imposed severe speed restrictions to prevent tracks from buckling.

SEE ALSO P12

Emirates begins checks on A380 jets after Airbus flags wing cracks

Latest checks relate to cracks discovered in a structural beam inside the wing

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Emirates will begin inspections of its Airbus A380 aircraft after European aviation regulators ordered urgent checks of the superjumbo's wing structure following findings from routine maintenance inspections. French jet manufacturer Airbus said five A380 aircraft with similar production histories have been identified for immediate inspection.

The Dubai-based airline, the world's largest operator of the A380, said it would comply with the airworthiness directive issued by the European Union Aviation Safety Agency (EASA), with inspections set to begin within the next 48 hours.

"Emirates will comply and carry out the inspections required in accordance with the airworthiness directive. Inspections will commence within the next 48 hours, and any work required will be carried out before releasing aircraft to service," the airline said.

Minimum disruption

"We remain in close contact with Airbus and the relevant authorities to minimise any disruption to the operating schedule," the airline said in a statement to *Gulf News*.

Airbus said the inspections stem from checks required under a December 2025 EASA airworthiness directive covering the aircraft's mid-spar structure — a key component of the wing that carries significant loads during flight.

"Following the December 2025 AD (AD 2025-0280), mandating inspections on the Mid Spars, specific findings prompted Airbus to inform EASA and to recommend inspections on a subpopulation of A380s," the aircraft manufacturer said. "All aircraft with similar histories were identified. There are five aircraft. Airbus is supporting the inspection of these five aircraft."

The latest checks relate to cracks discovered in a structural beam inside the wing. The European aviation safety agency issued additional inspection requirements after the findings raised concerns that damage in the area could affect the structural integrity of the wing.

SEE ALSO P10

WORLD CUP

Why Ronaldo was mocked despite scoring two goals

Ibrahimovic calls out Portugal star over his actions | P14-15

Paid parking hours extended until midnight across Sharjah

New operating hours to be implemented from July 1

DUBAI

BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Paid public parking hours across Sharjah will be extended until midnight from July 1 under a new decision announced by Sharjah City Municipality.

The move will apply to all paid parking spaces in the cities of Sharjah, Kalba, Khorfakkan and Al Dhaid, including parking areas identified by yellow signboards, bringing them in line with blue-sign parking zones that already operate until 12am.

The municipality clarified that parking will continue to be free on Fridays and official public holidays, except in designated zones where fees are charged throughout the week, including holidays.

124,000 spaces affected

The revised operating hours will affect approximately 124,000 paid public parking spaces across the emirate. Parking fees will now apply from 8am until midnight, although fee structures and operating mechanisms may differ in smart parking zones located across various areas of the emirate, particularly tourist destinations.

The extended hours are expected to encourage better use of public parking spaces, reduce random and illegal parking, and increase parking turnover in busy commercial and high-demand areas. The measure is also aimed at improving services in residential and commercial districts while supporting Sharjah's appeal as a tourism destination and a preferred place to live and spend leisure time.

NATION

UAE anti-drug campaign urges families, schools to join fight | P5

BUSINESS

New deadlines, rules and risks of UAE's e-invoicing explained | P8

ENTERTAINMENT

Deepika calls ICC maternity policy a 'landmark moment' | P16

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